

LUKE WHITAKER

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Customer success and instructional-technology professional with 7+ years of experience working in a SaaS and Higher Education environment. Highly skilled at establishing a trusted relationship with end-users, troubleshooting technical issues, onboarding and training stakeholders, and understanding technical requirements based on organizational needs.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Customer Success & Adoption** — onboarding, training, implementations, stakeholder management, value realization, retention
- **Technical Skills** — Software troubleshooting, C, Python, R, Git/GitHub
- **Data to Insight** — data validation & cleaning (ETL), regression analysis, reporting and visualization
- **AI** — Claude and the Claude Code CLI; published AI-in-education research
- **Communication** — technical writing, documentation, in-person and virtual training, email, and telephone

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Instructional Services Specialist

University of Iowa, Dept. of Spanish & Portuguese | Iowa City, IA | Oct. 2022–Present

- Acts as trusted technical advisor to faculty, staff, and IT, administering the Canvas/ICON LMS and delivering tiered support across a diverse user base.
- Onboards and train faculty and staff on instructional platforms, and authors the internal documentation and guides that improve consistency and reduces ramp time.
- Coordinates student-success projects across university systems (MAUI, Ad Astra, Campus Workflow) within FERPA constraints, guiding stakeholders through process and change.
- Builds and maintains a searchable multilingual digital archive and publish Open Educational Resources (Pressbooks) as a model for scalable knowledge sharing.

Project Specialist, HR/Payroll SaaS

Toast Inc. (formerly StratEx) | Chicago, IL | Apr. 2016–Aug. 2019

- Owned post-sales onboarding and training for hundreds of end-users and dozens of business stakeholders on an HR/payroll SaaS platform, driving adoption through complex, multi-stakeholder implementations.
- Managed implementations and custom configurations and partnered directly with developers to resolve issues and feed customer needs back into the product.
- Validated and cleaned large client datasets (.csv), resolving inconsistencies before production to protect data integrity across implementations.
- Authored configuration documentation and process standards that reduced onboarding time and improved consistency.

EDUCATION

- **M.A. in Linguistics** — University of Iowa, 2021
- **B.A. in International Politics/Relations** — University of Iowa, 2014.
Minors: Linguistics, French, Spanish.
Student Exchange: Aix-en-Provence, France.

LANGUAGES

English (native), Spanish (professionally fluent), French (professionally fluent)

PUBLICATIONS

- Zimotti, G., Smith, A.M., Frances, C., Whitaker, L., & Russell, J. (2026). Validating a Can-do self-assessment tool: validity, utility, and student reflections. *Second Language Research & Practice* [accepted].
- Zimotti, G., Frances, C., Whitaker, L., et al. (2024). The future of language education: Teachers' perceptions about the surge of AI writing tools. *Technology in Language Teaching & Learning*. <https://doi.org/10.29140/tltl.v6n2.1136>
- Whitaker, L. (2021). French interrogatives in context. University of Iowa. <https://doi.org/10.17077/etd.005964>